about one lakh and twenty thousand, half of whom were operating from Pakistan where the number of training camps had gone up from eighty to a hundred and six. Due to unabated violence, the country lived in an atmosphere of unease and apprehension. Both Afghan and Soviet officials at the middle and lower ranks gave the impression of being impatient at their inability to put an end to the violence.

An intelligence report circulated among top Indian officials said: 'The efforts of Afghan government to woo and win over the tribals by distribution of arms and financial doles met with little success. The changes in the council of ministers and various party organs have also not been able to create any perceptible impact. While the resentment against presence of Soviet troops as well as the Karmal regime has continued.'

The spies also found the Afghan forces inefficient. In an elaborate description sent from the war zone they noted: 'The present Afghan army by itself is not in a position to deal with insurgency situation because neither they have the strength nor the capability to do so. Therefore, as long as the Mujahideen are supported from outside, the Afghan army will continue to depend on the help of the Soviet Army.'

The Terrorists Pakistan Helped to Grow

A Joint Intelligence Committee (JIC) report sent to the cabinet secretary and principal secretary to Prime Minister Indira Gandhi on 25 November 1982 noted that at least six terror outfits had been raised by Pakistan to fight the Soviet forces in Afghanistan. All were headquartered in Peshawar, an ideal launch pad. At the top was the Hizb-e-Islami led by Gulbuddin Hekmatyar. The JIC report said Hekmatyar wanted Afghanistan to become an Islamic state. The Hizb-e-Islami maintained